

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The first staff begins with a 2/2 time signature, followed by a 3/2 time signature, and then returns to 2/2. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. Chord symbols (F, C, Bb) are placed above the staff. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The second staff ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'. The third and fourth staves continue the melody and lyrics, with the fourth staff ending with a double bar line and the word 'D.C.'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...